

Worship Rituals

- ↳ The objective of the religion is Purification of souls.
- ↳ Depends on relationship of servitude with the Almighty.

1. Prayers:

- ↳ The most important worship.
- ↳ Core of religion is acknowledging Allah's greatness, following his guidance and expressing gratitude & devotion.
- ↳ Prayer is the best way to express this.

Indeed, the prayer is a duty incumbent on the faithful to be discharged at appointed hours.
(4:103)

Importance of Prayer:

1. Foremost Directive:

- ↳ Prayer affirms belief in Oneness of God.

2. Requisite for Muslim Citizenship:

- ↳ Distinguishes a practicing Muslim and strengthens their identity within the community.

3. Means of strong Adherence to Islam:

- ↳ Prayer is a constant reminder of Islamic teachings.

4. Erases of sins:

- ↳ Helps in seeking forgiveness
- ↳ Purifies the heart and washes away minor sins.

5. Means of Countering hardships:

- ↳ Brings inner peace, strength, comfort and reliance on Allah's help.

6. Means of Perseverance on the truth:

- ↳ Helps believer stay firm on path of truth, resist doubts or temptations.

Objective of the Prayer.

- ↳ To remember and glorify Allah.

(Believers! Celebrate the praises of Allah in abundance and glorify Him morning and evening, (33:41 - 42)

How to avoid Laziness in Prayer?

- Understand importance of Prayer
- Remaining vigilant in remembering Allah.
- Purity of thoughts
- Protecting oneself from latent thoughts
- Praying in an audible manner.

2. Zakat:

↳ The second most important worship in Islam.

↳ In various religions, man has adopted to worship deities by presenting them a part of their wealth.

↳ In religions of prophets, this practice is referred to as Zakat.

And [in the daytime and at night] be diligent in the prayer and pay zakah and [for the cause of your religion and state] lend to Allah a befitting loan, and [remember] whatever good you send forth for yourselves you shall find it with Allah better than before and greater in reward. (73:20)

Those who are diligent in the prayer, pay zakah such that [their hearts] bow [down in humility]. (5:55)

↳ Importance of this ritual can be understood from the fact that like prayer, it is a pre-requisite to be a Muslim.

↳ Quran Says:

"So if they repent, become diligent in prayer and pay zakat, they are your brethren in religion."

↳ It is evident that after prayer, it is second manifestation of faith.

And those who whenever give, give such that their hearts are filled with awe knowing that they will have to return to their Lord. (23:60)

- ↳ Give Zakat for sake of Allah and not personal gain.
- ↳ They know Allah will see their intention and give them reward.

Heads of Zakat:

1. Poor and Needy
2. Salaries of employees of state
3. All political expenditure in interest of Islam and Muslim
4. For liberation of slaves
5. For helping people suffering economic losses or burdened with loan or fine.
6. For serving Islam and for welfare of Muslims.
7. For helping travellers.